

The FLYING MACHINE that gave the world wings

Airplane

The first airplane blazed a trail for supersonic jets and spacecraft, and helped make the world a much smaller place.

Did you know?

The Wright brothers' first flight only lasted 12 seconds and covered 120 ft (36.5 m).



Taking off

People had been trying to take to the skies for hundreds of years, with some even wearing feathers and leaping from high places. More successfully, the first **HOT-AIR BALLOON** went up in 1783, and the first passenger-carrying glider took off in 1849. But no one had mastered **powered flight**.



By the way...

My brother Orville flew the plane after my attempt stalled. We flipped a coin to see who would get the first try.

The Wrights' flight

The American brothers **WILBUR AND ORVILLE WRIGHT** had been fascinated with flight ever since their dad gave them a toy flier. They studied gliders and **built their own**. But the Wrights' glider had an extra element: an engine to propel it. In 1903, they made the world's first **powered flight**.

It paved the way for...



British engineer **Frank Whittle** invented the **JET ENGINE** in 1930.



IGOR SIKORSKY designed the first successful modern **HELICOPTER**, which flew in 1939.